

What Matters Most: A Sort

FILL IN TOGETHER

Parent and student each rank what matters in a college, separately, then compare. Most family arguments about college are two people optimising for different things without knowing it.

When: Before you build a list, and again if the list stops making sense

Rank these 1 to 12

Student fills the left column, parent fills the right. No conferring until both are done.

	Student rank	Parent rank
Total cost to our family		
Strength of the specific programme		
Distance from home		
Size of the school		
Campus feel and community		
Job or internship placement		
Diversity of the student body		
Support services (tutoring, counselling, disability)		
Athletics, arts or a specific activity		
Prestige and name recognition		
Safety		
Ability to come home easily		

Where we disagree most

Find the two rows with the biggest gap. Talk about those, not about colleges.

What we agree on

WORTH KNOWING

- ◆ Do this before touring anywhere. It changes which tours are worth the petrol.
- ◆ A gap is not a fight. It is information.
- ◆ Cost belongs on the list. Pretending it does not is how families end up with debt they never discussed.

